Diploma in Lightroom

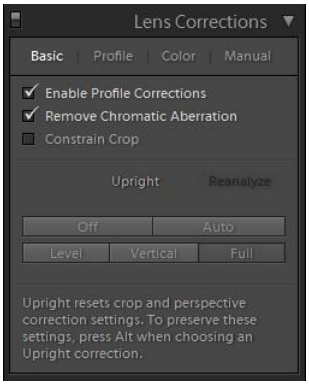
Lens Correction, Sharpening and Batch

What is lens correction in Lightroom?

Lens Corrections is a tool within Lightroom's Develop Module that allows fixing such lens problems as distortion, chromatic aberration, vignetting and perspective. The beauty of the Lens Corrections feature in Lightroom, is that just like any other setting, lens corrections can be copied from one image to another, applied to hundreds of images at once, or can be set up as an import template, automatically applying corrections to images during the image import process.

How to apply Lens Corrections to an Image

Applying distortion and vignetting corrections to an image within Lightroom is very simple – just go to the Develop module or press "D" on your keyboard, then move the right window down until you get to "Lens Corrections", and check "Enable Profile
Corrections" under the "Basic" tab as shown below:



Profile Tab

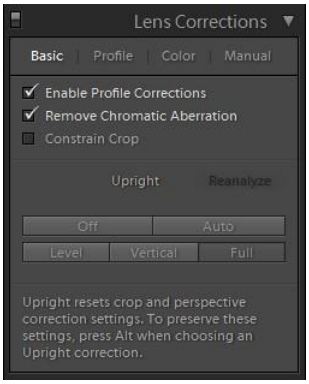
If you want to go into more options to modify or fine tune corrections, Lightroom provides additional tabs under the Lens Corrections sub-module. The "Profile" tab is the second tab after "Basic" and it contains fields that allow you to pick the lens of choice and apply custom distortion and vignetting levels, as seen in the below image:

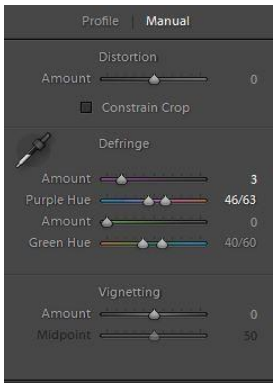
How to remove the chromatic aberration

What's a Chromatic Aberration?

It's when you see either a purple or green line around the edges of things in your image. It almost looks like someone took a thin magic marker and traced along the edges of objects (like mountains, buildings, etc.). In the image below, look on the edge of the fence (I've zoomed in really tight so you can see it).

You will see some purple-ish and green fringes. This is generally a lens problem (which is why the fix for it appears under the Lens Correction panel), but it can be exacerbated by adding a lot of clarity. Luckily it is very easy to fix as you can just turn on a checkbox or you can select the eyedropper tool and click on the colour that you want to remove.





How to Properly Sharpen Images in Lightroom

Adobe Photoshop Lightroom comes with powerful tools to sharpen images during post- processing. Located in the Develop module of Lightroom, the “Detail” box contains both Sharpening and Noise Reduction tools that allow Photographers to enhance their digital workflows by fine-tuning images and getting them ready to be published and printed in a quick and efficient way.

Where to find the sharpening Settings

1. Press “D” on your keyboard or click on “Develop” on the top right panel to get into the Develop module.
2. Left-click your image to view it at 100%. I highly recommend to view your images at full size (100%) before making any sharpening changes.
3. Expand the right panel in Lightroom and scroll down until you get to “Detail

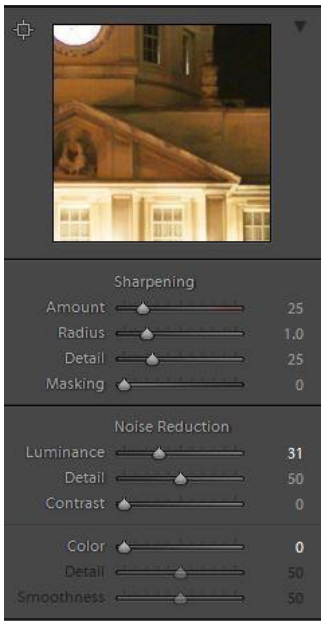
The Sharpening Tool has four different sliders:

1. **Amount** – the amount of sharpening you want to apply to an image. Zero means no sharpening is applied to the image. The higher the number, the more sharpening you will see. Too much sharpening will also increases the noise..

2. **Radius** – the size of the sharpening area around the edges. The default value of 1.0 means that Lightroom will apply sharpening over 1 pixel around the edge. If you increase the radius to a maximum value of 3.0, sharpening will be spread over three pixels around the edge, resulting in thicker, "shadowy" edges. I use the default radius value of 1.0 most of the time and I recommend to keep it under 1.5.
3. **Detail** – as the name suggests, the detail slider controls the amount of sharpening on the edges or "details" of the image. A small value like 0 only sharpens large edges, while a high value like 100 would sharpen even the smallest edges. For example, if you are working on an image of a bird, if you leave the detail at "0", only the edges of thick feathers would get sharpened, while using a larger number above 50 would bring out and sharpen even the thinner feathers. I try to stay below 50 on the detail slider, because higher numbers often considerably increase the amount of noise.
4. **Masking** – the most useful and versatile feature that masks out areas that should not be sharpened, similar to the mask tool in Photoshop.

Removing noise

To remove noise from a photo, open the Detail Panel in the Develop module to display the noise reduction sliders. There you will find sliders for Luminance noise and for Colour noise.

For raw images Lightroom automatically applies colour noise reduction in the import process. So the Colour Noise Reduction slider will be set, by default, to 25 with Detail and Smoothness set at 50 for all raw images.

Once you have adjusted the Luminance Noise slider you can then adjust its Detail and Contrast sliders. The Detail slider controls the luminance noise threshold – the higher the value the more detail in the image but, as a result, you may experience some residual noise. If you use a lower value you will get a smoother result but with less detail.